



Grade

10

Innovative English Olympiad

2025 – 2026

Total Questions: 50 | Time: 1.5 hr.

SET - A

Total Marks: 100

Instructions:

1. This question paper contains 50 questions. All questions are compulsory.
2. The duration of the examination is 90 minutes.
3. Each question carries 2 marks. There is no negative marks for wrong answers.
4. Use only blue or black ball-point pen to mark your answers on the OMR Answer Sheet.
5. The use of calculators, mobile phones, smart watches, log tables, or any electronic gadgets is strictly prohibited.

English

1. Choose the option in which the underlined word is used as a **noun**:
(A) The manager will **review** the report tomorrow.
(B) The film received a critical **review**.
(C) Please **review** your answers carefully.
(D) They were asked to **review** the decision.
2. Choose the most **appropriate analogy**:
Policy : Governance :: Curriculum : _____
(A) learning (B) assessment
(C) education (D) instruction
3. Choose the **synonym** of "*ambiguous*".
(A) clear (B) vague
(C) precise (D) explicit
4. Choose the **antonym** of "*conventional*".
(A) traditional (B) orthodox
(C) innovative (D) customary
5. Choose the sentence with **correct article usage**.
(A) He is an honest and hardworking leader.
(B) He is a honest and hardworking leader.
(C) He is the honest and hardworking leader.
(D) He is honest and the hardworking leader.
6. Choose the correct **homophone**:
She did not _____ the impact of her words.
(A) except (B) accept
(C) expect (D) adapt
7. Choose the correct option identifying a **homonym**.
(A) bark – tree covering / dog sound
(B) right – direction / correct
(C) fair – just / exhibition
(D) all of the above

8. Choose the sentence with correct **degree of comparison**.
 (A) This solution is more better than the previous one.
 (B) This solution is the best of all the proposed ones.
 (C) This solution is better than any solutions.
 (D) This solution is the most superior one.
9. Identify whether the underlined verb is **transitive or intransitive**:
The audience applauded loudly.
 (A) Transitive (B) Intransitive
 (C) Both (D) Neither
10. Choose the sentence with correct **sequence of tenses**.
 (A) She said that she will complete the work by evening.
 (B) She said that she would complete the work by evening.
 (C) She says that she would complete the work by evening.
 (D) She said that she completes the work by evening.
11. Choose the correct option distinguishing **fact, opinion, and inference**:
 "Based on the data, the project is likely to succeed."
 (A) Fact (B) Opinion
 (C) Inference (D) Assumption
12. Identify the **simple sentence**.
 (A) When the bell rang, the students left the class.
 (B) The students left the class after the bell rang.
 (C) The students left the class.
 (D) The students left the class and went home.
13. Choose the correct **indirect speech**:
 She said, "I have been working on this project for weeks."
 (A) She said that she was working on that project for weeks.
 (B) She said that she had been working on that project for weeks.
 (C) She said that she has been working on this project for weeks.
 (D) She said that she worked on that project for weeks.
14. Choose the correct **passive voice**:
They are finalising the agreement.
 (A) The agreement has been finalised.
 (B) The agreement is finalised.
 (C) The agreement is being finalised.
 (D) The agreement was being finalised.
15. Choose the **idiom** meaning "to examine something very carefully".
 (A) Turn a blind eye
 (B) Leave no stone unturned
 (C) Hit the roof
 (D) Bite the dust
16. Choose the correct **question form**.
 (A) You have finished the report, isn't it?
 (B) You have finished the report, haven't you?
 (C) You finished the report, didn't it?
 (D) You finished the report, isn't you?

17. Choose the correct **conditional sentence**.

- (A) If he will work hard, he will succeed.
- (B) If he works hard, he will succeed.
- (C) If he worked hard, he will succeed.
- (D) If he works hard, he would succeed.

18. Choose the sentence with **correct punctuation**.

- (A) However the proposal was rejected.
- (B) However, the proposal was rejected.
- (C) However the proposal, was rejected.
- (D) However; the proposal was rejected

19. **Identify the part with an error:**

Neither the principal nor the teachers was informed about the change.

- (A) Neither the principal
- (B) nor the teachers
- (C) was informed
- (D) about the change

20. Choose the correct **one-word substitute**:

A person who compiles dictionaries

- (A) Lexicographer (B) Linguist
- (C) Editor (D) Philologist

21. Choose the sentence that best reflects a **formal tone**.

- (A) I wanna inform you about the delay.
- (B) Just letting you know about the delay.
- (C) This is to inform you of the delay.
- (D) Delay happened, sorry.

22. Choose the correct **odd-one-out**.

- (A) diligent (B) industrious
- (C) lazy (D) hardworking

23. Choose the sentence with correct **adverb usage**.

- (A) She spoke confident in the meeting.
- (B) She spoke confidently in the meeting.
- (C) She confidently spoke in meeting.
- (D) She spoke with confidence confidently.

24. Choose the correct **cloze option**:

The committee decided to postpone the event _____ unforeseen circumstances.

- (A) because (B) due to
- (C) although (D) whereas

25. Choose the correct **word formation**:

Justify → _____

- (A) justification (B) justifiable
- (C) justifying (D) justified

26. Choose the correct **jumbled sentence**.

- (A) no sooner / had / the announcement / been made / than / protests / erupted
- (B) no sooner / the announcement / had been / made / than / erupted / protests
- (C) no sooner / had / been made / the announcement / than / protests / erupted
- (D) no sooner / had / the announcement / made been / than / erupted / protests

27. Choose the sentence expressing a **warning**.

- (A) Please complete the task by tomorrow.
- (B) If you continue to ignore the instructions, action will be taken.
- (C) I suggest you revise the rules.
- (D) Kindly submit the form.

28. Choose the correct **error correction**.
The data shows significant improvement.

- (A) show (B) showed
 (C) showing (D) shown

29. Choose the sentence with correct **fact vs opinion** distinction.

- (A) The movie is excellent.
 (B) The movie was released in 2022.
 (C) The movie should win awards.
 (D) The movie might be popular.

30. Choose the **antonym** of “meticulous”.

- (A) careful (B) precise
 (C) careless (D) thorough

31. Choose the correct **syllable stress**.

- (A) re-SPON-si-bi-li-ty
 (B) RE-spon-si-bi-li-ty
 (C) re-spon-si-BI-li-ty
 (D) re-SPON-si-BI-li-ty

32. Choose the correct **phrase usage**.

- (A) She is in charge of the project.
 (B) She is in charge for the project.
 (C) She is on charge of the project.
 (D) She is under charge of the project.

33. Choose the most appropriate **formal email opening**.

- (A) Hi Sir (B) Hey there
 (C) Dear Sir/Madam, (D) Hello

34. Choose the sentence expressing **polite disagreement**.

- (A) I don't agree with this at all.
 (B) This argument makes no sense.

(C) I respect your viewpoint; however, I differ on this matter.

(D) You are completely wrong.

35. Choose the most appropriate sentence for **seeking permission formally**.

- (A) Can I go early?
 (B) Please let me go early.
 (C) I request permission to leave early today.
 (D) I am leaving early.

36. Choose the sentence best suited for **consoling someone**.

- (A) This happened because you were careless.
 (B) Everyone faces setbacks; take this as a learning experience.
 (C) You should have been more careful.
 (D) Don't worry, it's not important.

37. Choose the correct **telephonic etiquette response**.

Caller: May I speak to the HR manager?

- (A) He is busy.
 (B) Hold.
 (C) May I know who's calling, please?
 (D) Call later.

38. Choose the sentence appropriate for **informing officially**.

- (A) I guess the meeting is cancelled.
 (B) The meeting scheduled for Friday has been cancelled.
 (C) The meeting was boring anyway.
 (D) Maybe there is no meeting.

For Questions 39 To 44 Read the passage carefully and Answer the questions that follow.

In recent years, the concept of sustainable development has gained prominence across policy discussions and academic research. It refers to development that meets present needs without compromising the ability of future generations to meet their own. While economic growth remains essential, unchecked industrialisation has led to environmental degradation, resource depletion, and climate instability. Governments now face the challenge of balancing progress with preservation. Renewable energy, responsible consumption, and inclusive growth models are increasingly being promoted. However, sustainable development also requires behavioural change at the individual level. Citizens must adopt environmentally responsible practices in daily life. Education plays a crucial role in shaping awareness and long-term commitment. Without collective effort, sustainability remains an ideal rather than a reality.

- 39.** What is the main idea of the passage?
- (A) Economic growth is harmful
 - (B) Sustainable development and its challenges
 - (C) Renewable energy is the only solution
 - (D) Education alone can solve environmental problems
- 40.** According to the passage, what has unchecked industrialisation caused?
- (A) Faster innovation
 - (B) Better living standards
 - (C) Environmental degradation
 - (D) Improved sustainability
- 41.** What role do individuals play in sustainable development?
- (A) None
 - (B) Only through voting
 - (C) By adopting responsible practices
 - (D) By opposing industrial growth
- 42.** Why is education important, as per the passage?
- (A) It ensures employment
 - (B) It promotes technological skills
 - (C) It builds awareness and commitment
 - (D) It increases economic output
- 43.** What challenge do governments face?
- (A) Reducing population
 - (B) Choosing between economy and environment
 - (C) Eliminating industries
 - (D) Promoting consumerism
- 44.** What underlying message does the passage convey?
- (A) Sustainability is unrealistic
 - (B) Individual effort is insignificant
 - (C) Collective action is essential
 - (D) Growth must stop immediately

For Questions 45 To 50 Read the passage carefully and Answer the questions that follow.

Public trust is a fundamental element of effective governance. When institutions operate transparently and are held accountable, citizens are more likely to engage constructively with public systems. Conversely, corruption and lack of transparency weaken democratic processes and breed cynicism. Over time, this erosion of trust can lead to social unrest and disengagement. Many countries have introduced reforms such as open data initiatives, independent oversight bodies, and whistle-blower protections to strengthen institutional integrity. However, reforms alone are insufficient unless supported by ethical leadership and informed citizen participation. Trust, once broken, is difficult to rebuild, making prevention far more effective than correction.

- 45.** What is the primary focus of the passage?
- (A) Economic reform
 - (B) Public trust in governance
 - (C) Role of technology
 - (D) Social welfare schemes
- 46.** What weakens democratic processes, according to the passage?
- (A) Public debate
 - (B) Transparency
 - (C) Corruption
 - (D) Oversight bodies

- 47.** What consequence can erosion of trust lead to?
- (A) Increased efficiency
 - (B) Greater accountability
 - (C) Social unrest
 - (D) Economic growth
- 48.** Which measures are mentioned to strengthen integrity?
- (A) Media regulation
 - (B) Judicial reforms
 - (C) Open data and oversight
 - (D) Political campaigning
- 49.** Why are reforms alone insufficient?
- (A) They are expensive
 - (B) They face opposition
 - (C) They require ethical leadership and public participation
 - (D) They reduce efficiency
- 50.** What does the passage suggest about trust?
- (A) It can be easily restored
 - (B) It is unimportant
 - (C) Prevention is better than rebuilding
 - (D) It depends only on laws

